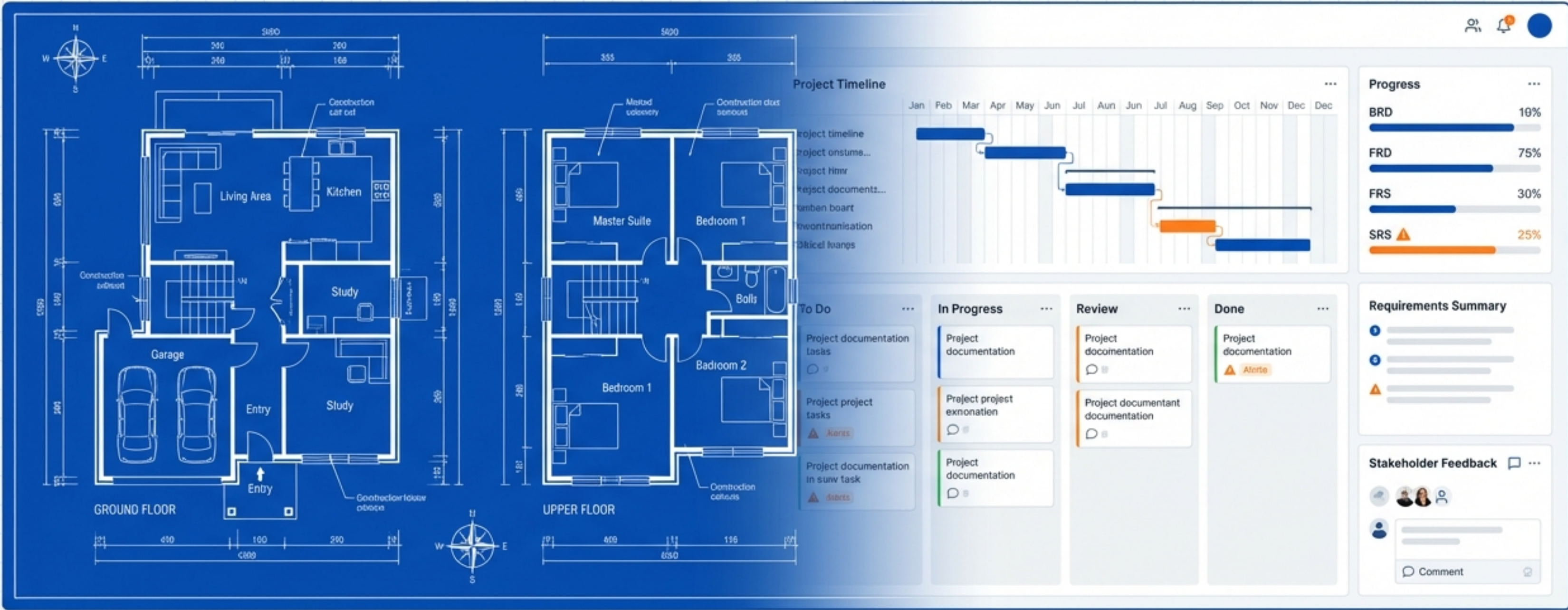


The Blueprint: Decoding Project Documentation

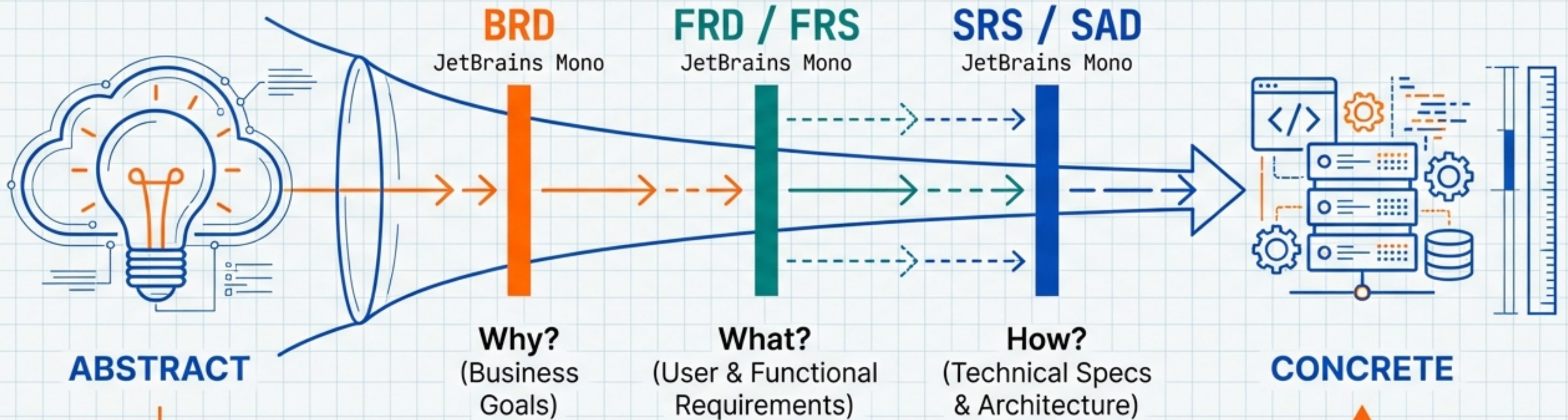
A visual guide to BRD, FRD, FRS, SRS, and SAD for Stakeholders, Developers, and Analysts.



FROM THE BOARDROOM TO THE SERVER ROOM

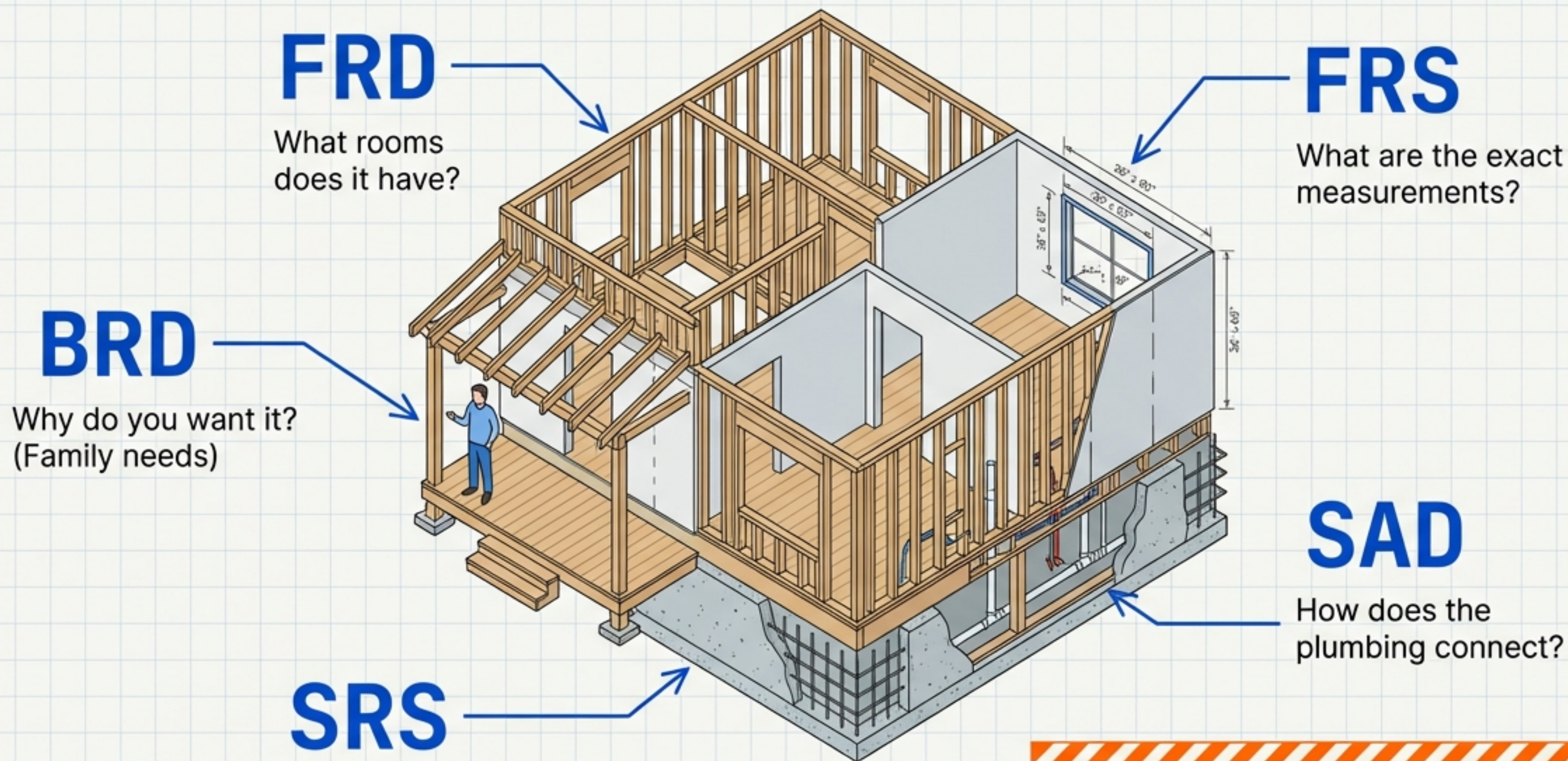
From Abstract Vision to Technical Reality

The Clarity Spectrum



Projects fail when we skip steps. Each document represents a necessary layer of resolution.

The Master Analogy: Building a House



 You wouldn't build a home without a blueprint.
Don't build software without one.

BRD: The Business Requirement Document

The Vision ("Why are we building this?")

The Analogy



My family has grown; renting is too expensive. I need a home.

The Reality (Grocery App)



Customers need faster delivery; current phone ordering is too slow and error-prone.

Key Sections & Audience Inter

- Business Background & Objectives
- Success Metrics (e.g., "Orders delivered within 90 minutes")
- In-Scope (Online ordering) vs. Out-of-Scope (Store inventory)



Audience

Business Users,
Sponsors, Project
Managers in
JetBrains Mono

FRD: The Functional Requirement Document

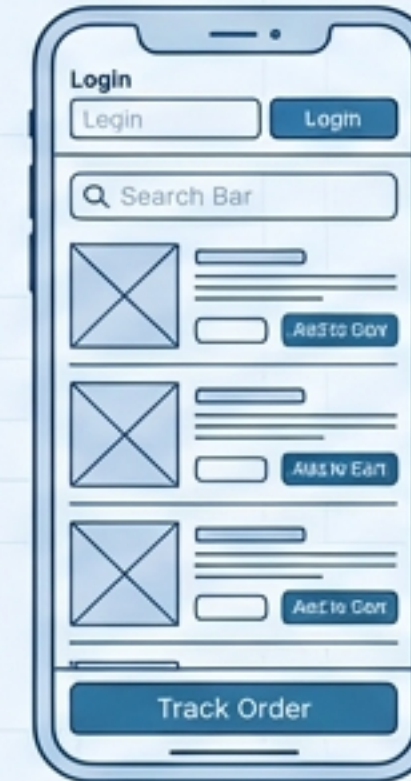
The User Experience ("What should the system do?")

The Analogy



The house needs 2 bedrooms, 1 kitchen, 2 bathrooms, and a parking spot.

The Reality (Grocery App)



User Login, Product Search, Order Placement, Delivery Tracking.

Key Sections & Audience

- User Roles
- Functional Modules
- Process Flows
- Business Rules (e.g., "System calculates final amount")



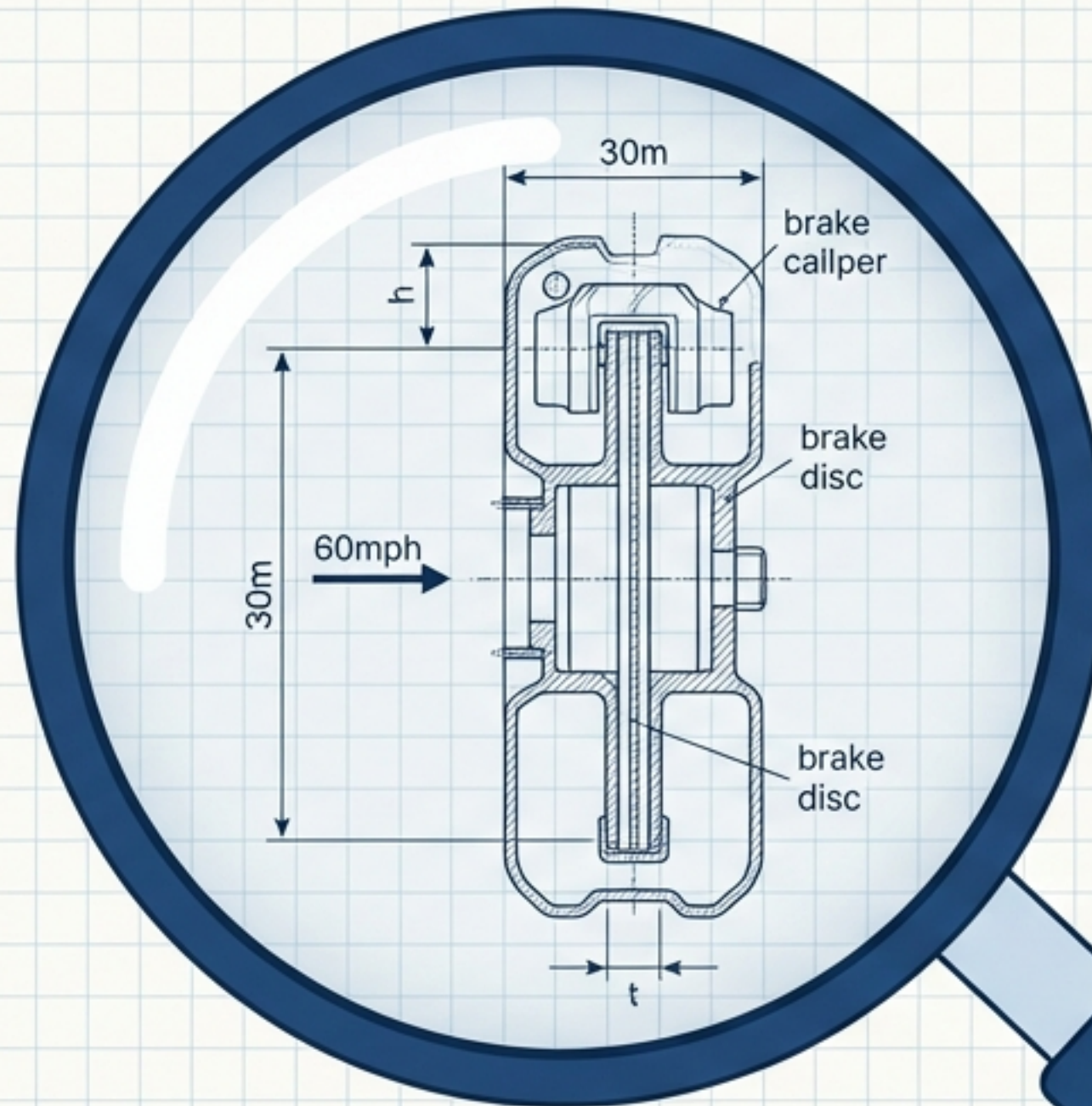
Audience
Business Analysts,
Developers, Testers

FRS: The Functional Requirement Specification

The Specifics ("Exactly how does it behave?")

FRD

The Feature:
"The car must have brakes."
(Focus: Existence)



FRS

The Logic:
"The brakes must stop the car within 30 meters at 60mph."
(Focus: Behavior & Constraints)

Real World Application



Input: Password field.

Logic: Min 8 chars; Account locks after 3 failures.

Output: Error message "Invalid username or password".

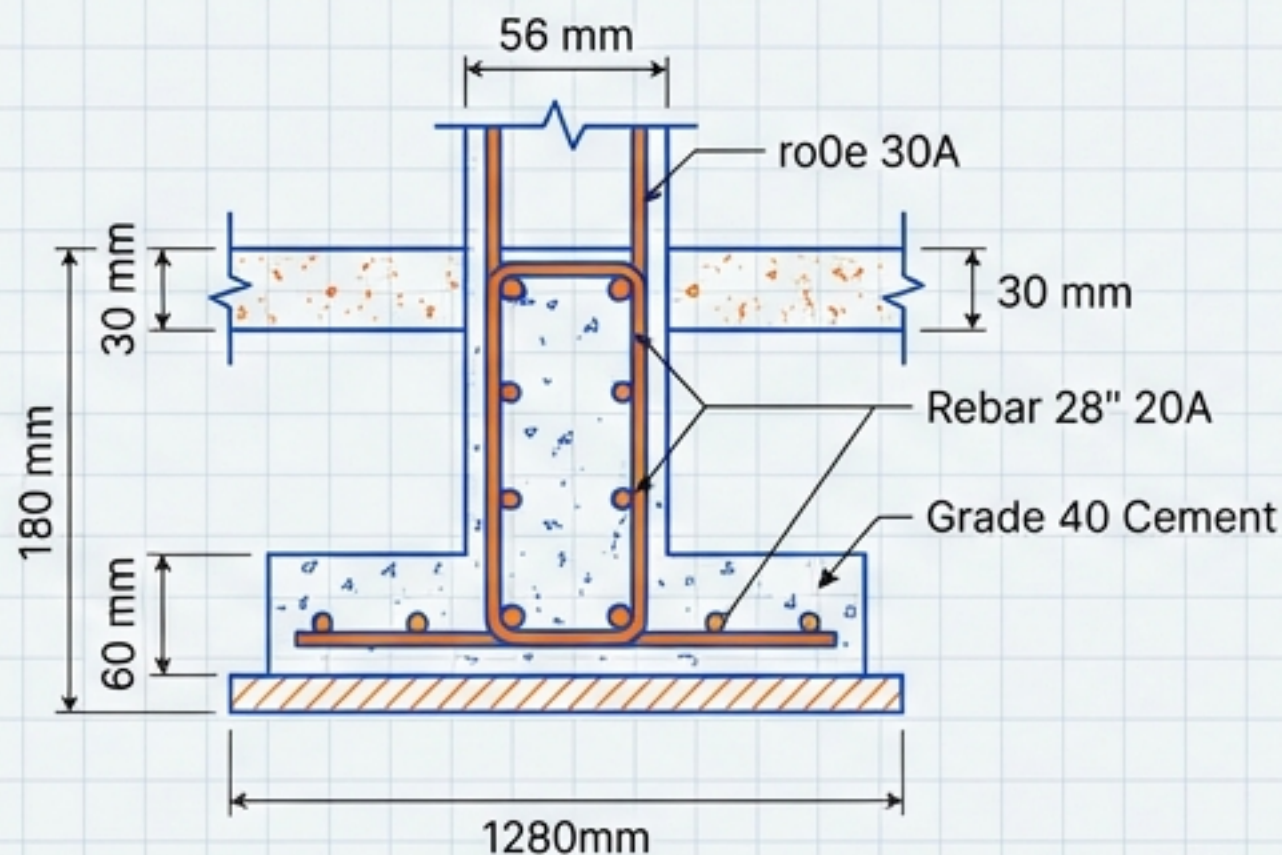


QA Teams
(Critical for test cases)
& **Developers**

SRS: The Software Requirement Specification

The Rules ("The technical blueprint")

The Analogy



Wiring standards, Grade 40 cement, foundation depth.

The Reality (Non-Functional Requirements)



Performance

Response time < 3 seconds



Security

AES-256 encryption



Status: **Active**

Availability

99.9% uptime

Key Sections & Audience

- Functional + Non-Functional Requirements
- Scalability & Compliance



Audience:

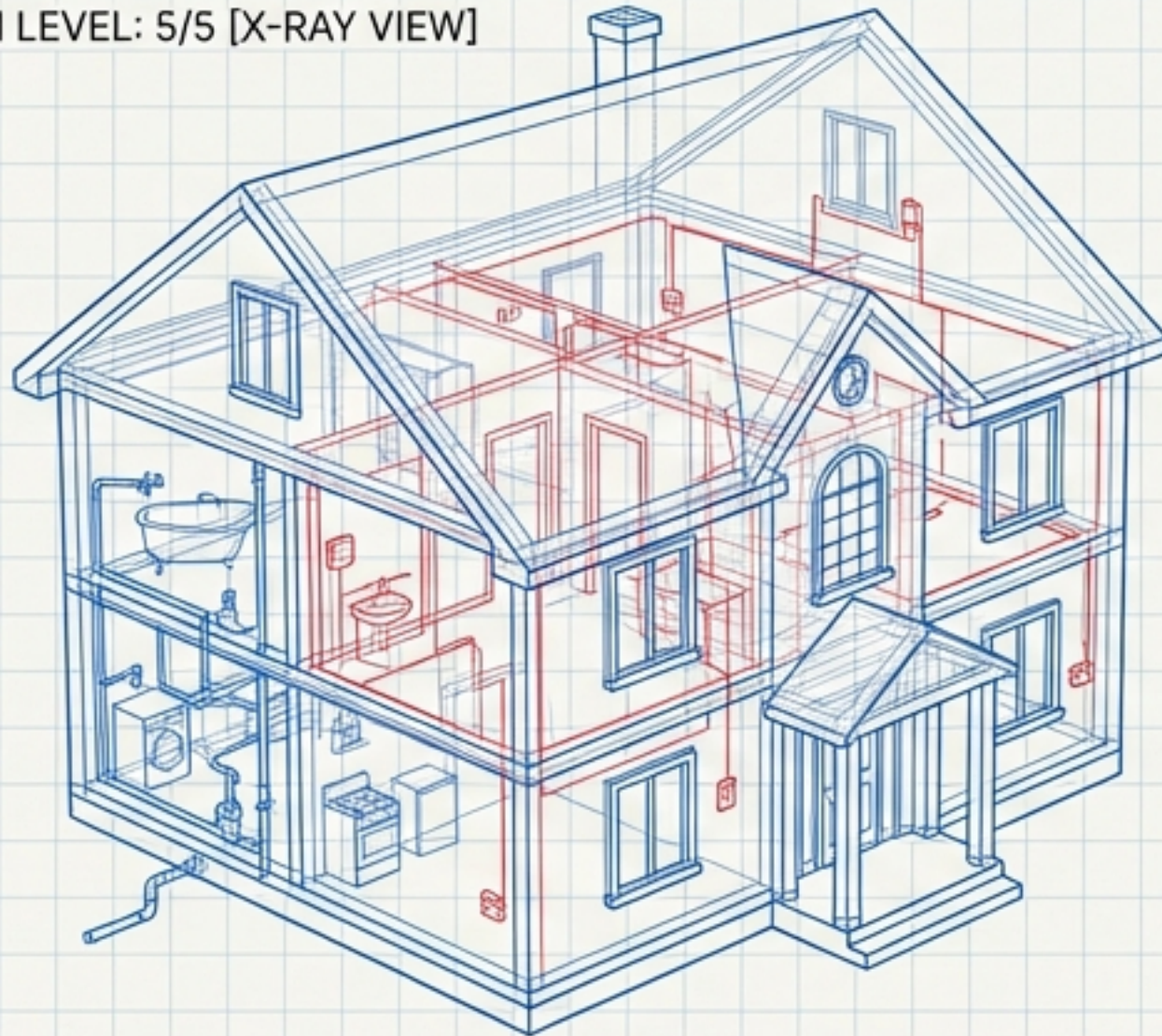
Developers & Architects

SAD: The System Architecture Document

The Structure ('How it all fits together')

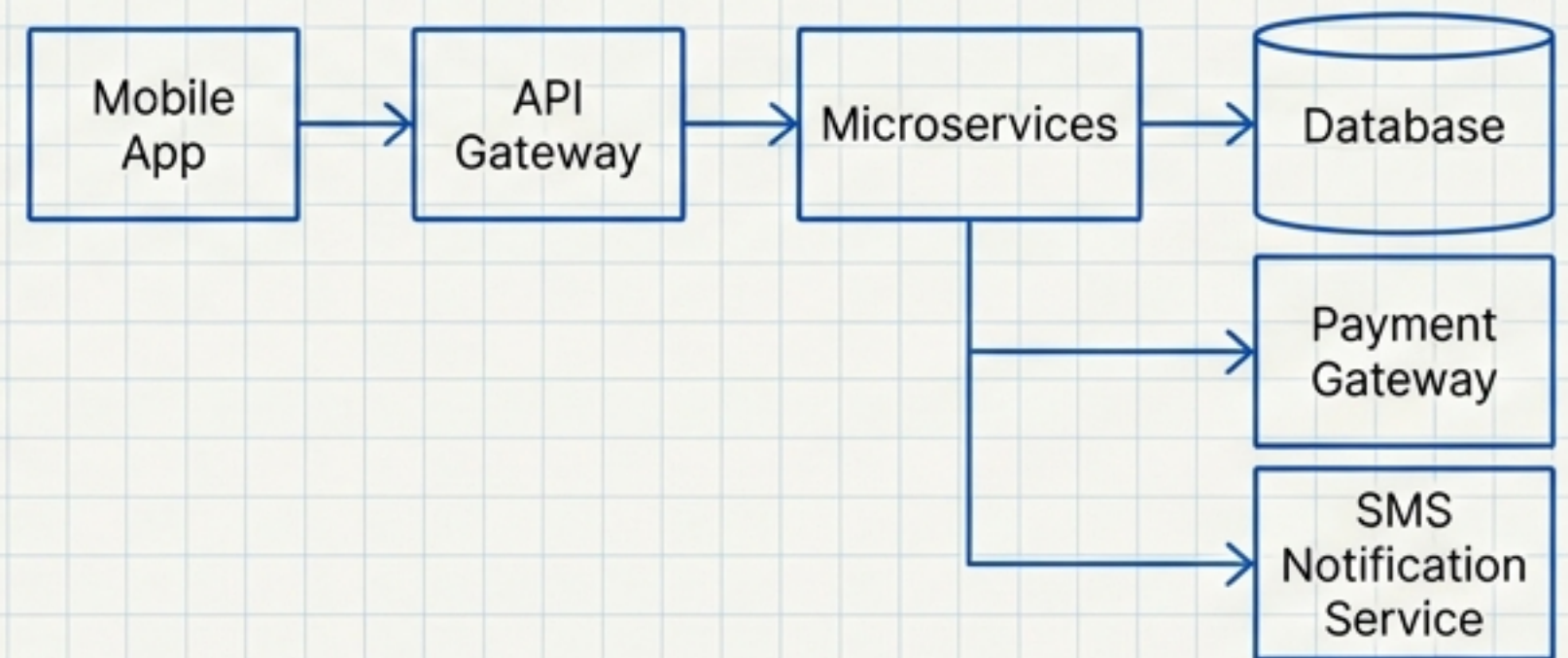
The Analogy

ZOOM LEVEL: 5/5 [X-RAY VIEW]



Electrical wiring diagrams, plumbing layout, HVAC integration.

The Reality (Tech Stack)



Key Sections & Audience

- Logical/Physical Architecture
- Data Flow Diagrams
- Deployment Design



Audience:
Solution Architects
& Senior Devs

At a Glance: The Documentation Matrix

Acronym		Simple Meaning	The Question	Primary Audience
BRD	BRD	Business Need	Why?	Business / PM
FRD	FRD	System Features	What?	BA / Dev / QA
FRS	FRS	Detailed Functions	What Exactly?	Dev / QA
SRS	SRS	Software Rules	How (Technical)?	Dev / Architect
SAD	SAD	System Design	How (Connects)?	Architect

Anatomy of a Document: Essential Sections

The Business (BRD)

- ✓ Business Background
- ✓ Problem Statement
- ✓ Scope (In/Out)
- ✓ Success Metrics
- ✓ Stakeholders

The Function (FRD/FRS)

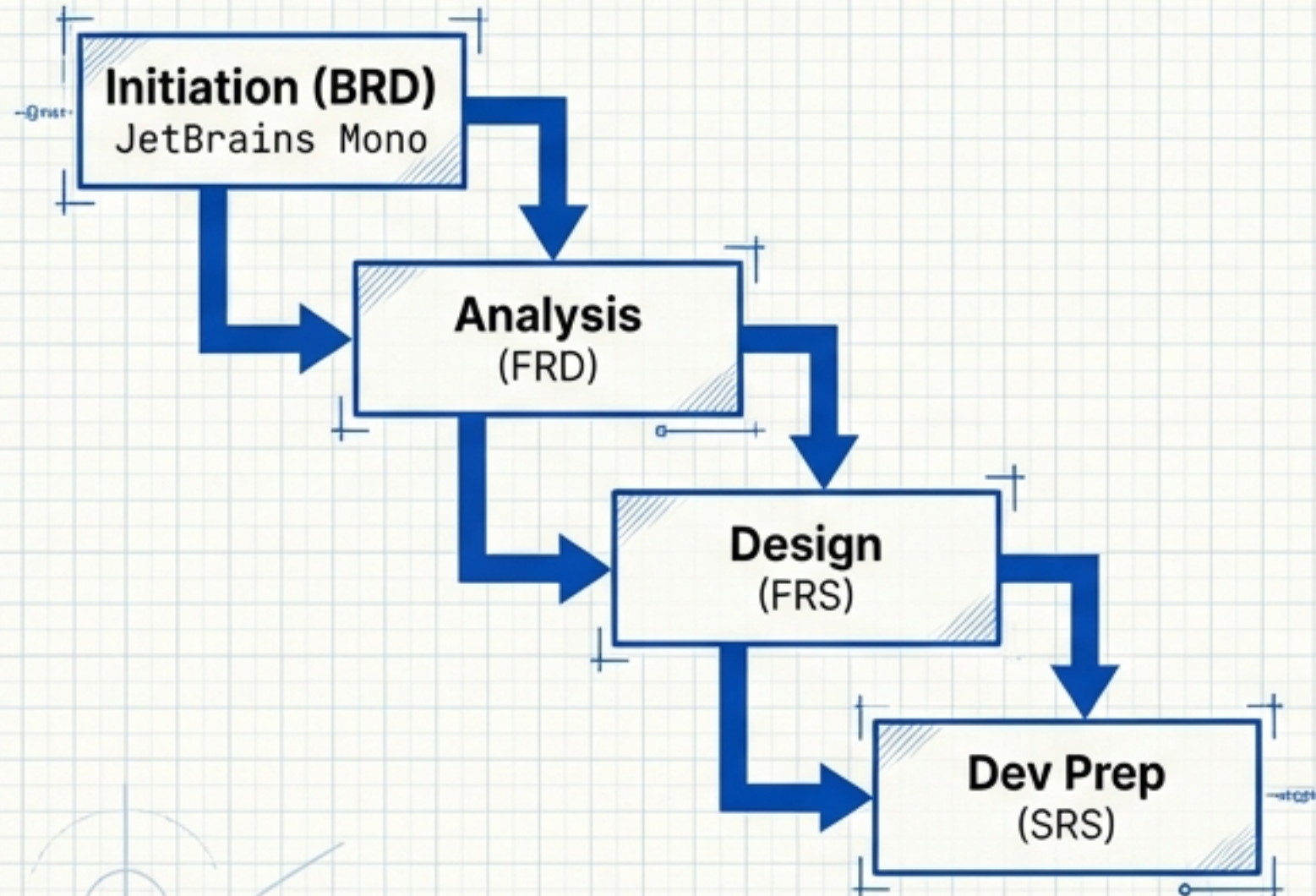
- ✓ Process Flows
- ✓ Use Cases
- ✓ Input/Output Logic
- ✓ Validations
- ✓ Error Messages
- ✓ Edge Cases

The Tech (SRS/SAD)

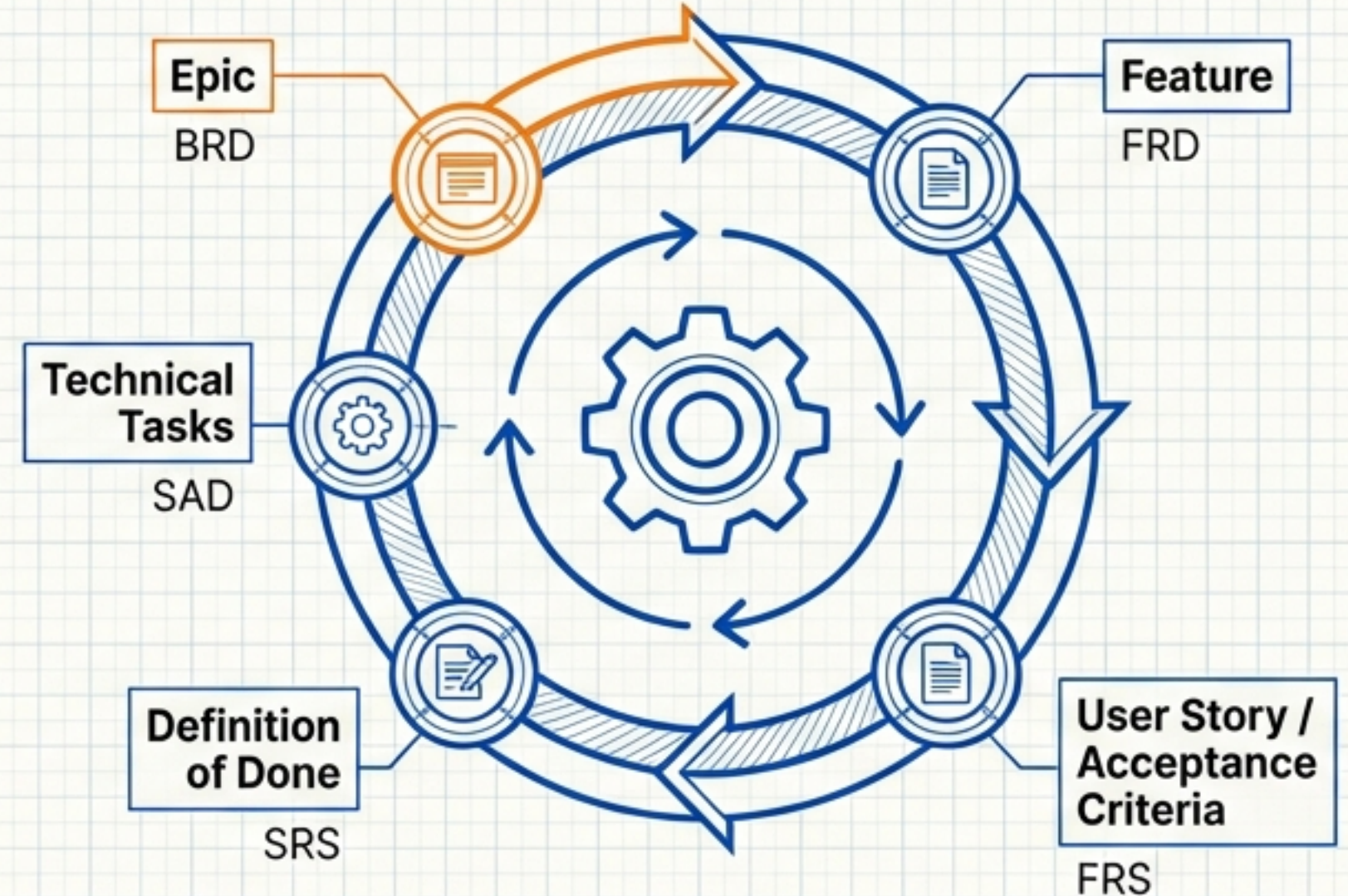
- ✓ NFRs (Speed/Security)
- ✓ Tech Stack
- ✓ Data Flow Diagrams
- ✓ API Integrations
- ✓ Deployment Architecture

Mapping to the SDLC: Waterfall vs. Agile

Waterfall



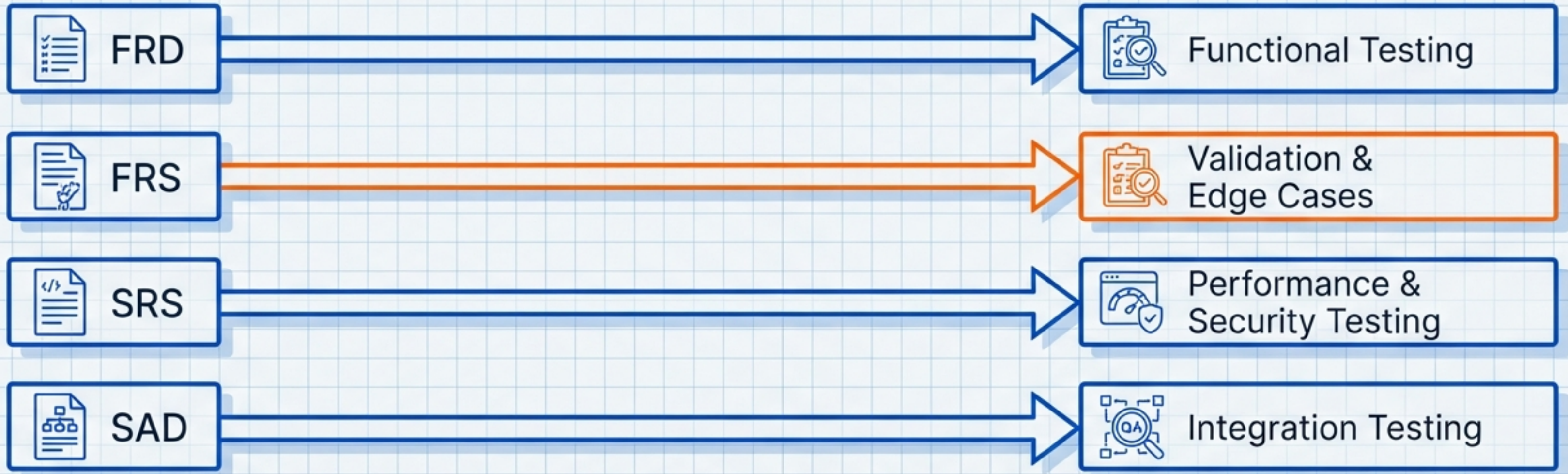
Agile / Jira



Agile doesn't kill documentation; it breaks it into smaller, iterative chunks (User Stories).

The QA Perspective: Deriving Test Cases

How documentation drives quality assurance.



Concrete Example:

Source (FRS): 'Password must be min 8 characters.'

Test Case A: Enter 7 chars → **Expect Error**.

Test Case B: Enter 8 chars → **Expect Success**.

Specialized Contexts: BFSI & Government

When 'Good Enough' isn't enough.



Key Characteristics

- ⦿ Heavy documentation & Audit trails (Mandatory)
- ⦿ Regulatory Compliance (RBI, SEBI, UIDAI)
- ⦿ Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) & Approval Matrices

Real World Example: Banking App requires data encryption and logged role approval workflows for every action.

The Interview Cheat Sheet

Ace the “Explain BRD vs. FRS vs. SRS” question.

**WHY → WHAT → WHAT (Detail) →
HOW (Rules) → HOW (Architecture)**

BRD: Vision & Need.

FRD: Functional Scope.

FRS: Functional Clarity (Logic).

SRS: Technical Rules.

SAD: System Blueprint.



Clarity is King



Key Takeaways

1. **Bridge the Gap:** Documentation connects Business vision with Technical execution.
2. **Respect the Layer:** Start with the Why, define the What, specify the How.
3. **Audience First:** Write for the reader—Business users need goals; Developers need rules.

Use the right blueprint for the right stage of construction.